

The CMAT exam pattern has been released by NTA on the official website <https://exams.nta.ac.in/CMAT/>. According to the CMAT exam pattern, the question paper consists of five sections: **Quantitative Techniques and Data Interpretation, Logical Reasoning, Language Comprehension, General Awareness, and Innovative and Entrepreneurial Skills.**

CMAT exam pattern 2026 is expected to remain the same as the previous year.

Each section of CMAT carries a weightage of 20 questions

The total number of questions in CMAT is 100

Total marks in CMAT are 400, maximum marks for each section is 80.

As per the CMAT marking scheme, +4 marks for a correct answer and -1 for a wrong answer.

Key Summary

The CMAT 2026 exam pattern includes 5 different sections, such as 1. **Quantitative technique and data interpretation**, 2. **Logical reasoning**, 3. **Language comprehension**, 4. **General awareness** and 5. **Innovative and entrepreneurship**.

The CMAT 2026 consists of 100 MCQ-type questions.

Each section of CMAT 2026 consists of 20 questions, each question worth 4 marks.

The correct answer will be awarded 4 marks, and in case of the wrong answer 1 mark will be deducted.

The arithmetic topic in quantitative technique and data interpretation has the highest weightage with 24%.

Reading comprehension gets the highest weightage in the language comprehension section with 60%.

Logical reasoning has equal importance across the topics, however verbal reasoning has slightly high weightage (16%) compared to other topics.

Static general awareness is the highest weighted average in general awareness with 90% weightage.

What is the CMAT Exam Pattern?

CMAT is a computer-based test conducted by the NTA. The CMAT exam pattern is released by NTA along with the registration information.

CMAT includes 100 MCQ-type questions.

The exam pattern includes 5 sections of CMAT syllabus such as 1. **Quantitative technique and data interpretation**, 2. **Logical reasoning**, 3. **Language comprehension**, 4. **General awareness** and 5. **Innovative and entrepreneurship**.

The time duration given to the students to solve the paper is 3 hours. There is no individual sectional time limit.

Each section has 20 questions, and the total number of questions is 100.

Total marks of CMAT is 400, with each question carrying 4 marks.

The CMAT exam will be conducted only in English language.

CMAT Particulars	Details
Exam Mode	Online
Duration	3 Hours

Language	English
Total number of shift	2
Sections	Quantitative technique and data interpretation Logical reasoning Language comprehension General awareness Innovative and entrepreneurship
Sectional time limit	No sectional time limit
Number of questions	100
Total Marks	400

Ques. What is the format of CMAT?

Ans. CMAT is the computer-based test consisting of 100 MCQs divided into 5 sections. Such as Quantitative technique and data interpretation, logical reasoning, language comprehension, general awareness and innovation and entrepreneurship.

Ques. Is there a sectional time limit in CMAT?

Ans. No, there is no sectional time limit in CMAT. Total duration of CMAT is 180 minutes (3 Hours) without sectional time limit. Students need to balance the time for the whole 5 sections.

Ques. What is the mode of the CMAT exam?

Ans. CMAT is conducted as a computer-based examination in pre-allocated test centers in 2 shifts.

Ques. Is the CMAT MCQ based?

Ans. Yes, CMAT is entirely MCQ based. CMAT consists of 100 MCQ-type questions.

What is the CMAT Marking Scheme?

As per the exam pattern released by the NTA, marking scheme is as follows

- Maximum marks can be obtained in each section is 80 marks, making the total marks of CMAT is 400.
- The correct answer will be awarded 4 marks.
- 1 mark will be deducted for each wrong answer.
- No marks will be given for unanswered questions.

Details	Marks
Correct answer	+4
Wrong answer	-1

No answer	0
-----------	---

Ques. How is the CMAT exam scored?

Ans. Each question in CMAT carries 4 marks. Correct answers are awarded 4 marks, incorrect answers get -1 marks, and no answer gets no marks or 0 marks.

Ques. Is there negative marking in CMAT?

Ans. Yes, there is negative marking in CMAT. Choosing the wrong answer will deduct 1 mark. The correct answers are awarded 4 marks each, and no answer will get no marks.

CMAT Exam Pattern: Sectional Weightage

The CMAT exam is divided into 5 sections. Each section carries 20 MCQ-type questions. The maximum marks that can be obtained is 80 marks per section. The difficulty level varies across question papers.

Section Name	Total Number of Question	Maximum Marks	Difficulty Level
Quantitative Technique and Data Interpretation	20	80	Easy to moderate
Logical Reasoning	20	80	Moderate
Language Comprehension	20	80	Moderate to Difficult
General Awareness	20	80	Moderate to difficult
Innovation and Entrepreneurship	20	80	Moderate

Ques. What is the sectional distribution of CMAT?

Ans. The sectional weightage of CMAT is as follows

- Quantitative techniques and data interpretation: 20 questions
- Logical reasoning: 20 questions
- Language comprehension: 20 questions
- General awareness: 20 questions
- Innovation and Entrepreneurship: 20 questions

CMAT Exam Pattern: Changes in the Last 5 Years

There have been no major changes in the CMAT exam pattern since 2022. Here are the most recent changes regarding the CMAT exam pattern.

CMAT 2021:

- The Innovation and Entrepreneurship section is introduced as an optional section with 25 questions. It didn't count for the calculation of percentile.

- Each section consists of 25 questions each.
- For the candidates who attend the section, 30 minutes extra.

CMAT 2022:

- The Innovation and Entrepreneurship section is now introduced as a permanent section and it is mandatory for all students.
- The number of questions in each section is reduced to 20.
- The exam duration is now fixed at 3 hours.
- All sections are counted for percentile calculations.

CMAT (2023 - 2026)

There are no significant changes in the CMAT exam pattern between 2023 - 2026.

- Exam duration remains 3 hours, and 5 mandatory sections remain unchanged.
- Each section consists of 20 questions.

Year	Questions	Sections	Exam Duration	Major Changes
2025,2024,2023	100	• Quantitative and data interpretation • Logical reasoning • Language comprehension • General awareness • Innovation and Entrepreneurship	3 hours	No major changes
2022	100	• Quantitative and data interpretation • Logical reasoning • Language comprehension • General awareness • Innovation and Entrepreneurship	3 hours	1. The Innovation and Entrepreneurship section was made compulsory to all candidates. 2. Exam duration is fixed at 3 hours for all. 3. All sections are now counted for percentile calculations. 4. The number of questions for each section is reduced to 20 questions.

2021	100/125	- Quantitative and data interpretation - Logical reasoning - Language comprehension - General awareness - Innovation and Entrepreneurship (Optional)	3 hours/3.5 hours	- Innovation and Entrepreneurship section is introduced as an optional section. - For students who attempt the 5th optional section, the exam duration is 3.5 hours; otherwise, it was 3 hours. - Innovations and Entrepreneurship sections did not count for percentile calculation.
------	---------	--	-------------------	---

Ques. Is it compulsory to attend the Innovation and Entrepreneurship section?

Ans. Yes, the Innovation and Entrepreneurship section is compulsory. It is counted towards the percentile calculations. This section has a weightage of 20 questions, with each question carrying 4 marks, making it worth 80 marks.

Ques. Are there any changes in the CMAT 2026 exam pattern from the previous year?

Ans. There are no significant changes in the CMAT 2026 from CMAT 2025.

- There are 100 MCQ-based questions. 20 questions in each section.
- The exam duration is 3 hours. Total marks is 400.
- +4 for the correct answer, -1 for incorrect answer.

CMAT Exam Pattern 2026: Chapter-wise Sectional Weightage

As per the official NTA, The CMAT exam pattern is divided into 5 sections. Each section covers the questions from the various topics. Below are the topics and their topic-wise weightage, including number of questions and their percentages.

Quantitative Technique and Data Interpretation

Among all the topics in quantitative and data interpretation, arithmetic has the highest weightage with 6 questions, followed by geometry having 5 questions.

Algebra has a weightage of 3 questions out of 20 questions. All other topic gets

Topic Name	Total number of questions	Weightage in Percentage
Algebra	3	16%
Arithmetic	6	24%
Geometry	5	28%
Data Interpretation	2	8%

Modern Maths	2	16%
Miscellaneous	2	8%

Language Comprehension

Highest weightage of 60% comes from 4 Passages for reading comprehension questions.

Synonyms and antonyms will approximately get 2 questions.

Topic Name	Total number of questions	Weightage in percentage
Reading Comprehension - 4 passages	10	60%
Synonyms and Antonyms	2	8%
Fill in the blanks	1	4%
Error correction	1	4%
Idioms	1	4%
Para jumbles	1	4%
Word analogy	1	4%
Meaning of phrase	1	4%
Word meaning	1	4%
Correct the sentence	1	4%

Logical Reasoning

Verbal reasoning gets the highest weightage with 4 questions, while other topics get around 1 - 2 questions each.

Topic Name	Number of questions	Weightage in percentage
Verbal reasoning - statement argument, statement conclusion, word relationship, Assertion reason	4	16%

Odd one out	2	12%
Coding - decoding	2	12%
Blood relations	2	12%
Series completion	1	8%
Visual reasoning	1	8%
Analogy	2	8%
Logic based	1	4%
Counting number of squares in a figure	1	4%
Ranking	1	4%
Square arrangement	1	4%
Directions	1	4%
Miscellaneous	1	4%

General Awareness

Static GK covers various topics such as history, geography, the Indian constitution, economics, literature, etc. Static GK has the highest weightage with 18 questions, while current affairs get 2-3 questions.

Topic Name	Number of questions	Weightage in percentage
Static GK	17-18	90%
Current affairs	2-3	10%

Ques. How many marks are in the quant and DI sections in CMAT?

Ans. Quant and DI section has a weightage of 20 questions, with each carrying 4 marks. So the quant and DI section gets 80 marks in total.

Ques. Can I skip any section in the CMAT if I am weak in it?

Ans. It is technically possible to skip any section, but it is not advisable to skip completely, since every section carries 80 marks. You can minimize the preparation time, but please do prepare for important topics from the section to get at least partial marks.

Ques. Is the logical reasoning section more important than any other section in CMAT?

Ans. No, the logical reasoning section has equal weightage as other sections. Every section consists of 20 questions, and each worth 80 marks.

CMAT 2026 Preparation Tips

CMAT 2026 preparation should be done as per the exam pattern and syllabus. Go through the entire syllabus and analyse the exam pattern to understand the structure of the exam. Tips below may help you prepare well for CMAT 2026.

- Candidates must plan and allocate their time to studies and stick to the plan. Allot the time according to the difficulty level. Make sure every section is covered.
- Gradual and regular revision helps in familiarizing with the topics, basics of the topics, types of questions and important questions.
- Try to solve the previous year's CMAT question paper as much as possible.
- Do practice sectional mock tests, and overall mock tests to analyse what your strengths and weaknesses are.
- Work on speed and accuracy by learning shortcut methods and tricks to solve problems.

Ques. How to improve time management skills for the CMAT exam?

Ans. CMAT requires speed and accuracy to solve problems in CMAT since 100 questions need to be solved in 180 minutes. Solving mock tests and sample papers is the best way to practice time management. And learning shortcut methods, tricks and formulas will help you solve the problems so fast.

Ques. How many hours should I dedicate to CMAT preparation?

Ans. If you are a beginner who is just starting to understand the CMAT exam patterns, 7 - 8 hours of focused study is required. But if you already know about the CMAT exam pattern and concepts, then 3-4 hours of study would be enough.